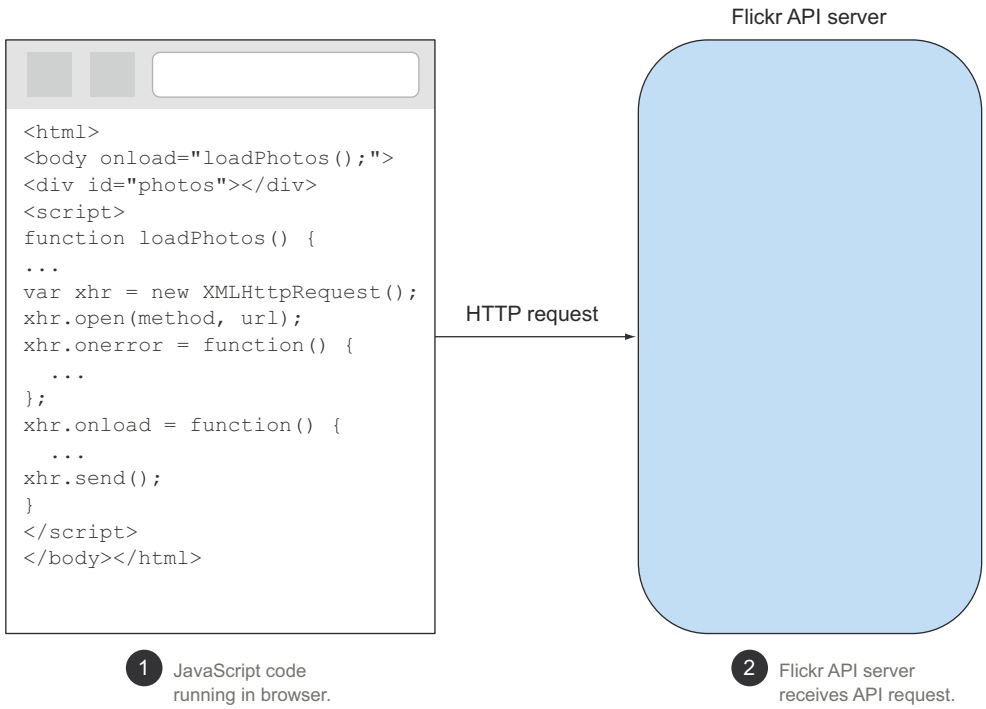


Figure 2.3 Making a request from the browser to the Flickr API

Now let's apply this analogy to the Flickr example from chapter 1. In that example, there is JavaScript code running in the browser, which initiates a request to the Flickr API, as shown in figure 2.3. This request is a cross-origin request because the JavaScript code making the request and the API server receiving the request live on two different websites.

There are a lot of different pieces to making a successful cross-origin request. The client and the server must work together to ensure that the request succeeds. This chapter focuses on the first part of this process: how the client initiates a request to the server ❶. Let's start by taking a look at which browsers do and don't support CORS.

2.2 Browser support for CORS

Browser support for CORS can be divided into three tiers: full support, partial support, and no support. If you're developing with CORS, it's helpful to know which browsers your users are using, so you know which of these three tiers you need to focus on.

CORS is fully supported in the following desktop browsers:

- Chrome 3+
- Firefox 3.5+
- Safari 4+